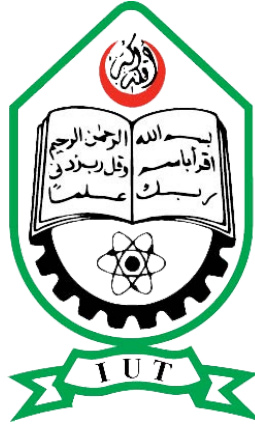


Islamic University of Technology



Visual Programming Lab

CSE 4402

Final Project Report

GariAche

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GariAche - IUT Carpooling Android App

GariAche is a mobile carpooling application designed exclusively for the students of the Islamic University of Technology (IUT). It provides a platform for students to offer and find rides, primarily between the IUT campus and various destinations in Dhaka, fostering a sense of community and providing a cost-effective transportation solution.

GitHub repo: [GariAche](#)

Core Features

- **User Authentication** : Secure sign-up and login system restricted to users with an @iut-dhaka.edu email address.
- **Offer a Ride** : Allows users (drivers) to post ride details, including destination, time, available seats, and price.
- **Find a Ride** : Enables users (passengers) to search for available rides based on their destination and date.
- **Ride Booking** : A seamless process for passengers to book one or more seats in an available ride.
- **Booking Management** : Users can view their booked rides and have the option to cancel a booking up to 30 minutes before the departure time.
- **User Profile** : Displays user information, confirming their status as a verified IUT student.
- **Dynamic UI** : The interface dynamically updates to prevent users from booking their own rides or rides that are already full.

Technology Stack & Key Concepts

This project was built using native Android development with Java, leveraging fundamental Android components and a local SQLite database for data persistence.

- **Language : Java**
- **Database : SQLite** - A localSQLiteOpenHelper class is used to manage the database schema (creation, upgrades). All user data, rides, and bookings are stored locally on the device.

- **UI/UX :**
 - **Android XML Layouts :** All user interfaces are built using XML.
 - **Material Design Components :** The UI is styled using components from the Material Design library (CardView,TextInputEditText,MaterialAutoCompleteTextView,Button) for a modern and intuitive user experience.
 - **RecyclerView :** Used efficiently to display lists of rides and bookings. This is a key component for performance with dynamic lists.
 - **Dynamic View Inflation :** Search results and ride lists are created by programmatically inflating item layouts (ride_item.xml, booking_item.xml) and adding them to a parent container or RecyclerView.
- **Core Android Components :**
 - **Activities :** The application follows a multi-activity architecture, with each screen representing a distinct task.
 - **Intents :** Used for navigation between activities and for passing data (e.g., ride details for booking).
 - **SharedPreferences :** Used for lightweight session management, specifically for storing thecurrent_user_idafter a successful login.
 - **Dialogs :** DatePickerDialog,TimePickerDialog, and AlertDialog are used for user input and confirmations, providing a native and user-friendly experience.
- **Architecture :**
 - The application employs a standard **Activity-based architecture**. Each activity is responsible for managing its own UI and business logic.
 - Data is passed between activities via Intent extras.
 - A centralDatabaseHelperclass manages all database interactions, separating database logic from the UI controllers (Activities).

Database Schema

The application uses a local SQLite database named GariAche.db with three main tables.

1. users

- id(INTEGER, Primary Key, Autoincrement)
- student_id(TEXT, UNIQUE, NOT NULL)
- name(TEXT, NOT NULL)
- email(TEXT, UNIQUE, NOT NULL)
- phone(TEXT)
- password(TEXT, NOT NULL)

2. rides

- id(INTEGER, Primary Key, Autoincrement)
- driver_id(INTEGER, Foreign Key tousers.id)
- pickup_point(TEXT)
- destination(TEXT, NOT NULL)
- ride_date(TEXT, NOT NULL)
- ride_time(TEXT, NOT NULL)
- available_seats(INTEGER, NOT NULL)
- price_per_seat(INTEGER)
- car_model(TEXT)
- car_color(TEXT)
- license_plate(TEXT)
- notes(TEXT)
- status(TEXT, e.g., 'active')

3. bookings

- id(INTEGER, Primary Key, Autoincrement)
- ride_id(INTEGER, Foreign Key torides.id)
- passenger_id(INTEGER, Foreign Key tousers.id)
- booked_seats(INTEGER, NOT NULL)
- passenger_phone(TEXT, NOT NULL)
- notes(TEXT)
- booking_date(TEXT)
- status(TEXT, e.g., 'confirmed', 'cancelled')

Activity & Logic Breakdown

1. SplashActivity

- **Purpose** : The initial entry point of the app, displaying the app logo and name.
- **UI (activity_splash.xml)** : A simple centered layout with an ImageView for the logo and TextViews for the app name and tagline.
- **Logic (SplashActivity.java)** :
 - **Technique** : Uses a Handler().postDelayed() method to create a short delay (500ms).
 - After the delay, it creates an Intent to navigate to LoginActivity and then calls finish() to remove the splash screen from the back stack.

2. LoginActivity

- **Purpose** : To handle user authentication (both login and sign-up).
- **UI (activity_login.xml)** :
 - Features two distinct forms (LinearLayout) for Login and Sign-Up.
 - The visibility of these forms is toggled programmatically, providing a clean "single screen" experience for the user.
- **Logic (LoginActivity.java)** :
 - **Mode Toggling** : A boolean isLoginMode flag tracks the current state. A TextView(toggle_text) acts as a button to switch between login and sign-up modes by changing text and form visibility.
 - **Sign-Up (handleSignup)** :
 - **Validation** : Enforces that all fields are filled and that the email address ends with @iut-dhaka.edu.
 - **Database Interaction** : Queries the userstable to ensure the email or student ID does not already exist before inserting a new user.

- **Login (handleLogin) :**

- **Database Interaction** : Queries the userstable for a matching email.
- **Authentication** : Compares the provided password with the stored password from the database.
- **Session Management** : On successful login, the user's id is retrieved from the database and stored in SharedPreferences under the key current_user_id. This acts as the session token for the rest of the app.
- **Navigation** : Redirects to HomeActivity on success.

3. HomeActivity

- **Purpose** : The main dashboard or home screen after a user logs in.
- **UI (activity_home.xml)** : A clean, card-based layout.
 - Two primary actions, "Find a Ride" and "Offer a Ride", are presented as large, clickable CardViews.
 - Secondary actions like "My Profile", "My Bookings", and "Logout" are provided as TextViews at the bottom.
- **Logic (HomeActivity.java)** :
 - **Authentication Check** : In onCreate(), it immediately checks SharedPreferences for current_user_id. If not found, it redirects the user back to LoginActivity.
 - **Navigation** : Uses setOnClickListener on the cards and text views to create Intents that navigate to the respective activities (FindRideActivity, OfferRideActivity, etc.).
 - **Logout** : The logout button clears all data from SharedPreferences and navigates back to LoginActivity, effectively ending the user's session.

4. OfferRideActivity

- **Purpose** : Allows drivers to create and post a new ride.

- **UI (activity_offer_ride.xml)** : A comprehensive form built with TextInputEditText for ride details.
 - The "Pickup Point" is fixed to "IUT" and is not editable.
 - A MaterialAutoCompleteTextView is used for the "Destination," providing a dropdown list of predefined locations from res/values/string.xml.
- **Logic (OfferRideActivity.java)** :
 - **User Input** : Uses DatePickerDialog and TimePickerDialog to ensure valid date and time formats.
 - **Validation** : The handlePostRide() method performs extensive validation to ensure all required fields are filled correctly.
 - **Database Insertion** : On successful validation, it retrieves the current_user_id from SharedPreferences and creates a new record in the rides table in the SQLite database.
 - **Navigation** : On success, it passes the new ride's details to OfferRideSuccessActivity via Intent extras.

5. FindRideActivity

- **Purpose** : Allows passengers to search for available rides.
- **UI (activity_find_ride.xml)** :
 - A search form for destination and date.
 - A NestedScrollView contains a Linear Layout(rides_container) where search results are dynamically added.
 - A "No rides found" message is shown if the search yields no results.
- **Logic (FindRideActivity.java)** :
 - **Database Search** : The searchRidesInDatabase() method constructs and executes a SQLSELECT query on the rides table with WHERE clauses for destination, date, and status.

- **Dynamic UI Generation** : The `displaySearchResults()` method iterates through the Cursor results. For each ride, it inflates the `ride_item.xml` layout, populates its TextViews with ride data, and adds the view to the `rides_container`.

- **Conditional Logic** :

- It fetches the `current_user_id` from `SharedPreferences` to check if a ride is owned by the current user. If so, the "Book" button is disabled and styled differently.
- It also disables the button if `available_seats` is 0.

- **Navigation** : The "Book" button `onClick` listener creates an Intent to `BookingConfirmationActivity`, passing all the necessary ride details.

6. BookingConfirmationActivity

- **Purpose** : To allow a user to confirm the booking of a selected ride.

- **UI (activity_booking_confirmation.xml)** :

- Displays the details of the ride passed from the previous activity.

- Provides input fields for the number of seats and phone number.

- A "Total Amount" TextView is updated dynamically.

- **Logic (BookingConfirmationActivity.java)** :

- **Data Reception** : Retrieves ride details from the Intent extras.

- **Dynamic Price Calculation** : A `setOnFocusChange` Listener is attached to the seats input field. When the user finishes editing the number of seats, `updateTotalPrice()` is called to calculate and display the total cost (`price * seats`).

- **Booking Logic (handleBookingConfirmation)** :

1. Validates the user's input.
2. Retrieves `current_user_id` from `SharedPreferences`.
3. Inserts a new record into the bookings table.

4. Executes an UPDATE query on the rides table to decrement the number of available_seats.
5. Navigates to BookingSuccessActivity on success.

7. ViewMyRidesActivity & BookingsAdapter

- **Purpose** : To display a list of all rides the current user has booked.
- **UI (activity_view_my_rides.xml)** : The main element is a RecyclerView to efficiently handle a potentially long list of bookings.
- **Logic (ViewMyRidesActivity.java)** :
 - **Data Fetching** : The loadMyBookings() method executes a complex SQLJOINquery to fetch booking details along with the corresponding ride and driver information from the bookings, rides, and users tables.
 - The results are stored in a list of BookingWithRideInfo data class objects.
- **Adapter Logic (BookingsAdapter.java)** :
 - **View Binding** : Binds the BookingWithRideInfo data to the views inside booking_item.xml within the onBindViewHolder method.
 - **Cancellation Logic** :
 - The canCancelBooking() method calculates the time difference between the current time and the ride's departure time. It returns true if the difference is more than 30 minutes.
 - The "Cancel" button's state (enabled/disabled) and text are set based on the result of this method and the booking status.
 - If clicked, an AlertDialog is shown for confirmation. If confirmed, the cancelBooking() method updates the booking's status to "cancelled" in the database and notifies the adapter to refresh the view.

8.ProfileActivity

- **Purpose** : To display the profile information of the logged-in user.

